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GOING GREEN WEF says building strong industries and supply chains constitutes a key point of India's strategy

26 |

RENEWABLE ENERGY

LEADING BY EXAMPLE

The World Economic Forum has lauded India's pragmatic approach in clean energy. It feels the country will become an important hub for clean hydrogen in the future

BY **RICHA SHARMA**

► **"THE WORLD'S ENERGY** future hinges on India's energy future," said US Energy Secretary Jennifer Granholm recently.

Echoing her words, Maciej Kolaczowski, Manager, Advanced Energy Solutions Industry of World Economic Forum (WEF) says India has taken a very pragmatic approach by balancing investments both in clean energy solutions and fossil-based power to meet its energy needs.

Kolaczowski, who, on a trip to India in September-end, met domestic industry players in advanced energy solutions, says the country has set bold goals, focussing on clean

hydrogen, energy storage, carbon capture, and green aviation fuel. "By 2030, the country plans to pour more than \$35 billion each year into these energy projects (not counting solar or wind). India needs to invest \$9-10 billion annually just for battery storage. At the same time, there are these very pragmatic approaches, where India invests in fossil-based generation (80GW coal-fuelled power by 2031-32) to meet its ever-growing energy needs, when there is not enough wind and sun," he says.

Aditya Lolla, Asia Programme Director at independent energy think tank Ember believes India's clean

\$35
billion

**AMOUNT INDIA PLANS
TO SPEND EACH YEAR
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BY 2030**